

The Print Media can Slash Costs if it Switches to Open Source



The Kerala chief minister addressing dignitaries and an attentive audience at a media event

The Malayalam newspaper *Janayugam* has switched to GNU/Linux with Scribus. The team at Alpha Fork Technologies, which has enabled this change, and Rajaji Mathew Thomas, the editor of the newspaper, had an exclusive interaction with Sreejani Bhattacharyya of *OSFY* to discuss the various aspects of this switch. They also talked about how open source software could reduce the costs of the players in the print media space.

“We think FOSS is the ultimate future. If the print media switches to free and open source software (FOSS) their economic burden will fall considerably,” says Mujeeb Rahman K., co-founder, Alpha Fork Technologies.

Rajaji Mathew Thomas, editor, *Janayugam*, adds, “The move to open source software did help us reduce the cost of OSs and software migration by almost one-third from what it would have been for the proprietary alternative available in the market.”

Alpha Fork Technologies is an IT company built upon FOSS. It provides services like Web development, software development, IT infrastructure management and technology

consultation. Ranjith Siji and Mujeeb Rahman K. are the co-founders of the company. Other team members include Ambady Anand S., and Kannan V.M.

The *Janayugam* team earlier used Adobe Pagemaker for all the pre-press processes. But the team constantly received demands from its readers for better quality fonts and readability. So the management looked for an up-to-date, efficient software that would help them to do so. Thomas says, “We first thought of available proprietary software like Adobe InDesign, but we found it unaffordable for a medium-sized newspaper like ours. Such a shift in the software also requires upgradation of the system, including the OS. We even thought of abandoning the modernisation project